



For Staff

## Allegation of Sexual Harassment or Sexual Violence

Responding when a student tells you another student has sent them sexual messages or touched them sexually without consent, in school, online or at a party

### Content Warning

This guide covers sexual harassment, sexual assault and image-based abuse between children.

**This is reference guidance, not a training course.** Use it to check how to respond, or to prepare for a conversation. It does not replace the school's safeguarding training, policy or the DSL's advice on a specific case.

It contains descriptions of sexual harassment and sexual assault between children, unwanted sexual messages and images, and the police and social care response. Some of it may be difficult to read, particularly if it connects with your own experience or that of someone close to you.

- You can read it in sections, take a break, or step away at any point.
- If this raises something personal, you can speak in confidence to your line manager, a senior colleague you trust, or the school's Employee Assistance Programme, if it has one, or **Education Support** (free, confidential, 24/7 on 08000 562 561). The **Rape Crisis 24/7 Support Line** is free, any time, on 0808 500 2222, for anyone aged 16 and over.
- If you have a question about how this guidance applies to a situation you are dealing with, speak to your school's Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).

**If reading this makes you worried about a child now, do not wait until you have finished reading: speak to the DSL or a deputy straight away. If a child is in immediate danger, call 999.**

**Immediate danger or possible risk to life:** call 999 when it is needed, stay with the child, and summon the DSL or a deputy. Don't delay action to work through the steps. The 90-second Pause is for once immediate safety is secured, to stop an impulsive or investigative response. **Go to the Quick Reference Card.**

## Why This Matters

Sexual harassment between children is common enough that many young people see it as normal. When Ofsted spoke to more than 900 children and young people, **nearly 90% of girls, and nearly 50% of boys, said being sent explicit pictures or videos of things they did not want to see happens a lot or sometimes** to them or their peers ([Ofsted, 2021](#)). In police-recorded child sexual abuse and exploitation in England and Wales in 2024, **half of these offences were committed by children aged 10 to 17** ([VKPP, 2025](#)).

**KCSIE 2026** Part five sets out how schools respond to child-on-child sexual harassment and sexual violence, **including incidents outside school and online** (paragraph 529). Abuse that happens online or outside school should be treated with equal seriousness, however long the child has taken to come forward (paragraph 557). The way a school first responds matters: a supportive response can empower victims to come forward, while a poor response may discourage further disclosures (paragraph 556).

## Scenario Overview

**A Year 10 student stays after class and discloses that another student has been sending them explicit messages and touched them inappropriately at a party last weekend.**

### What to Keep in Mind

- **The student chose you.** KCSIE asks staff to recognise the significance of being chosen as a confidant, and to respond with empathy (paragraph 558).
- There are **two parts to the report**: unwanted sexual messages (online sexual harassment) and sexual touching without consent (which may be sexual assault). Both need a safeguarding response. You don't decide which it is; the DSL, and where needed the police, do.
- **It happened off site, at the weekend, and online.** It is still the school's safeguarding concern: both students are likely to be in school on Monday, in the same corridors, classes or group chats.
- **The messages may include images.** Staff never view, copy, forward or delete them (UKCIS).
- **A few days have passed.** Delay does not make a report less credible (paragraph 557).
- **Both students are children**, and both need a safeguarding response. Support for the student alleged to have caused harm does not reduce the protection of the student who told you. Where a student is 18, see the note for the DSL under Notify.

- A single incident is enough to act on. **You don't need to wait for it to happen again.**

**Language in this guide.** KCSIE uses "victim" and "alleged perpetrator". With students, use their words, and never label the other student.

### How RESPOND Works in This Scenario

RESPOND is powered by **ACT: Active Intervention** (inaction is not neutral), **Contextual Safeguarding** (this harm crossed a party, phones and a peer group) and **Trauma-Informed Practice** (safety, dignity and choice). The steps are taught in order but work as a **helix**: see *The RESPOND Helix* section.

| Step               | RESPOND tool                                                | In this scenario                                                                                |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● <b>Recognise</b> | 4 Ps Context Scan                                           | Sexual harassment online and a possible sexual assault off site; both students children         |
| ● <b>Engage</b>    | Disclosure script; TED questions                            | Believe, listen, use their words; don't scroll through the messages, as they may include images |
| ● <b>Support</b>   | Safety check first; "Your calm is contagious"               | Are they safe now, hurt, and is the other student on site today?                                |
| ● <b>Pause</b>     | 90-second grounding; Three Lenses (Risk, Rights, Resources) | Don't investigate, confront, promise secrecy, or touch the evidence                             |
| ● <b>Offer</b>     | Model alternatives; if in doubt, N before O                 | Explain honestly what happens next; give the choices that are theirs                            |
| ● <b>Notify</b>    | DSL, as soon as is practicably possible                     | For a report of sexual assault: now, in person or by phone                                      |
| ● <b>Document</b>  | GOLD standard                                               | Their exact words; that you did not view any images                                             |

**RESPOND is not a checklist to complete in order. Immediate danger or possible risk to life: act first (999 when needed, stay with the child, summon the DSL or a deputy), then return to the steps.**

**Need the essentials?** The *Quick Reference Card* at the end of this guide covers the immediate response and escalation on one page.

**The One Chance Rule:** a disclosure may be a young person's only attempt to seek help. Make it count.

## The RESPOND Helix: How the Steps Move

RESPOND is taught in a line, Recognise to Document, because sequence gives structure under pressure. In practice it moves as a helix. The first dimension is the steps themselves: you may loop back, hold at a step, or go straight to Notify. The second is time and severity: each turn sits higher as a concern develops. The third is context: a concern involving several children, places or platforms traces a wider spiral.

### Relational and Systemic

For a child, safeguarding is **relational**: it happens through people they trust. For the adults around them, it is also **systemic**: the steps, records and shared decisions that make sure what a child tells one person reaches the people who can help.

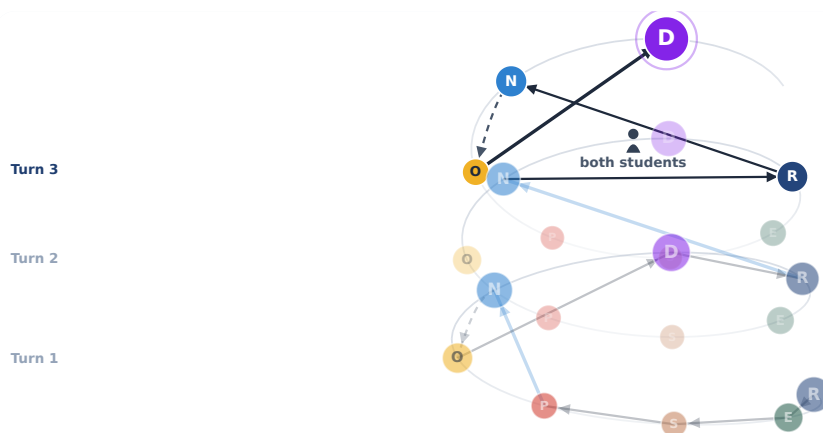
**Relational is why children tell. Systemic is why telling works.**

The RESPOND steps follow the same shape: Recognise, Engage and Support are relational; Pause is the bridge; Offer, Notify and Document are the systems steps. Neither works alone. Relationship without the system becomes secrecy, which is why staff never promise to keep a disclosure to themselves. The system without relationship becomes process that children do not trust enough to use. When you share information, be open with the child about what you are sharing and why.

## See It Move

An example: a direct disclosure after class. Then see a wider spiral, where a group chat and other students are involved, and what happens when steps are skipped.

*This is a still image of the interactive RESPOND Helix. Open the web version of this guide to step through the examples; every example is also written out in full below.*



## ▼ Read the helix demonstration as text

### Sequence

How RESPOND is taught.

1. **The seven steps:** RESPOND is taught in this order, Recognise to Document, because sequence gives structure under pressure. Recognise, Engage and Support are the relational steps; Pause is the bridge; Offer, Notify and Document are the systems steps.
2. **But practice is not a line:** A report of sexual harassment or sexual violence rarely arrives complete. Children often tell a little at a time, and what happened online and offline is often tangled together. You may loop back, hold at a step, or go straight to Notify. Choose an example to see how the steps move.

### A disclosure after class

A Year 10 student stays behind and tells their teacher that another student has been sending them explicit messages, and touched them sexually at a party last weekend. Both students are children: the helix wraps around both of them.

1. **Turn 1: the disclosure:** The student says: "He keeps sending me stuff I don't want, and at the party he grabbed me." Recognise: this is a report of sexual harassment (the messages) and possible sexual assault (the touching). It happened off site and online; that does not change the response.
2. **Turn 1:** Engage: listen, use their words, and use the script: "I believe you, and I'm taking what you've told me seriously. This is not your fault. I'm going to help keep you safe, and I'll explain what happens next." Ask only open questions: "Tell me what happened." The student offers to show you the messages. You say, kindly, that you won't look at them.
3. **Turn 1:** Support: are they safe now? Are they hurt? Is the other student in school today? They are due in a lesson that the other student is also in. They stay with you.
4. **Turn 1:** Pause: 90 seconds, then Three Lenses. Don't investigate, don't promise secrecy, don't speak to the other student, and don't look at, forward or delete anything on the phone.
5. **Turn 1: N before O:** Notify before Offer: this is a report of sexual assault and the other student is on site, so the DSL is told now, in person or by phone, before the student goes back into the school day.
6. **Turn 1:** Offer, once the DSL is involved: explain what happens next, honestly. Give the choices that are theirs: who is with them, when they speak to the DSL, how their parents are told.
7. **Turn 1:** Document: GOLD, as soon as is practicably possible. Their exact words; that you did not view the messages; what you said would happen next.
8. **Turn 2: the next day:** The student's tutor notices them crying at registration. A friend says people are talking about the party in a group chat, and that someone is saying there is a video.
9. **Turn 2: straight to Notify:** Go straight to the DSL: a possible video of a child and online harassment are new risks. Don't ask anyone to show you the chat or find the video.
10. **Turn 3: weeks later:** The police tell the DSL they will take no further action. The student has stopped going to lunch and asks to drop a subject they share with the other student.
1. **Turn 3:** Notify: the DSL reviews the risk and needs assessment and the arrangements for both students.
2. **Turn 3:** Offer: model alternatives. A timetable change if the student wants it, specialist support, and a plan they helped shape. You never leave a step behind.
3. **Turn 3:** Document: GOLD, and keep the chronology going. Decisions and their reasons are recorded.

## Wider spiral

One report, several strands: the party was shared online, and other students are taking sides.

1. **Three strands:** A Year 10 student reports being touched at a party. The alleged perpetrator's friends are posting about it, and other students who were at the party are talking. A single concern traces a tight spiral; this one is wider.
2. **Joined up:** Everything goes to the DSL: one joined-up picture. Don't question the other students or look at the chat yourself.
3. **Once the DSL has decided:** Offer: support and a safety plan for the student who told; support alongside any sanctions for the alleged perpetrator; for the wider group, clear expectations about taking sides and online harassment, and education on consent.
4. **Every strand:** Every strand ends in Document. Harassment of either student, or of witnesses, belongs in the record.

## When it breaks

The same disclosure after class, when steps are skipped.

1. **Turn 1:** The student tells a teacher about the messages and the party. Recognise happens.
2. **Pause skipped:** The teacher scrolls through the messages on the student's phone "to see how bad it is", then asks the other student for their side. Pause is skipped: an image of a child may have been viewed, and the other student now knows.
3. **Notify skipped:** The teacher decides it was "a party thing" and tells only a colleague. The DSL never hears. Professionals working in isolation, and information not being shared, are recurring findings in reviews of serious cases.
4. **Document skipped:** Nothing is recorded. When another student later reports the same boy, there is nothing to connect it to.
5. **The helix fragments:** The student has learned that telling makes things worse, and stops telling. Messages are deleted. That is how harm escalates unseen.
6. **Put it back together:** Every step taken puts the structure back. Relational is why children tell; systemic is why telling works.

The Helix is described in the RESPOND Safeguarding Operating System (section 5.2). All examples are fictional.

# R

## RECOGNISE: Know What You Are Hearing

**You are hearing a report of sexual harassment and possible sexual violence between children. You don't need to be certain, and you don't need to decide whether a crime has been committed: you need to recognise that this is a safeguarding concern for the DSL.**

## The 4 Ps Context Scan

### People

Who is the other student? Their age, year and any power they hold (older, popular, bigger, in a position of status). Who else was at the party? Who knows?

### Places

A party off site at the weekend; now school on Monday: shared lessons, corridors, clubs, transport and, for boarders, the house

### Platforms

The explicit messages: which app, whether images were involved, whether anything from the party was filmed or shared, and group chats

### Patterns

Has it happened before, to this student or others? Is it escalating from messages to touching? A single incident is enough to act on

## The KCSIE Definitions

### Sexual Harassment

"Unwanted conduct of a sexual nature" that can happen online and offline, inside and outside school. It can violate a child's dignity, make them feel intimidated, degraded or humiliated, and create a hostile, offensive or sexualised environment (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 539).

- Sexual comments, remarks and "jokes"; sexualised names
- Physical behaviour such as deliberately brushing against someone or interfering with their clothes
- Online: unwanted sexual comments and messages; sharing unwanted explicit content; making or sharing nudes or semi-nudes, consensual or not; coercing someone into sharing images

Examples from paragraph 540. Schools should consider sexual harassment in broad terms (paragraph 541).

### Sexual Violence

In KCSIE, sexual violence means specific offences under the Sexual Offences Act 2003: rape, assault by penetration, sexual assault, and causing someone to engage in sexual activity without

consent (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 543).

KCSIE notes that sexual assault covers a very wide range of behaviour: a single act of kissing someone without consent, or touching someone's bottom, breasts or genitalia without consent, can still be sexual assault (paragraph 543).

## Signs a Student May Have Been Harmed

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- Changes in mood, withdrawal from friends, or avoiding a particular person, place or lesson
- Talking about a party or a person in a way that suggests fear or shame
- No visible signs at all: children respond to sexual violence in very different ways, and some show no overt signs (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 625)

### No Disclosure Needed

Children may struggle to tell. Disclosure can come indirectly: through a friend, an overheard conversation, or a change in behaviour. Staff should act on any concern about a child's welfare rather than wait to be told (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 555). Pass what you notice to the DSL and record it factually.

## What the Law Says (England and Wales)

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- **Statutory definitions are not the same as criminal offences.** "Sexual harassment" is a safeguarding definition in KCSIE 2026 (paragraph 539). Some is also a crime; either way it needs a safeguarding response.
- **Sexual assault** is an offence where a person intentionally touches another person, the touching is sexual, the other person does not consent, and the person does not reasonably believe they consent (Sexual Offences Act 2003, section 3).
- **Consent:** a child under 13 can never consent to any sexual activity, and the age of consent is 16 (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 543). KCSIE stresses the difference between consensual activity between children of a similar age and activity involving any power imbalance, coercion or exploitation, and says the DSL should generally lead that judgement (footnote to paragraph 543).
- **Images:** taking, making or sharing an indecent image of anyone under 18 is an offence, including an image a young person takes of themselves (Protection of Children Act 1978, section 1). Intentionally sending a photograph or film of genitals to cause alarm, distress or humiliation, or for sexual gratification while reckless about that, is also an offence (Sexual Offences Act 2003, section 66A).
- **Age:** the age of criminal responsibility in England and Wales is 10 (CPS). Where a report of rape, assault by penetration or sexual assault is made, the starting point is that it is passed to the police; if the alleged perpetrator is under 10, the police take a welfare approach (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 598).

**Staff should not decide whether an offence has been committed.** Report the concern to the DSL. Legal references checked 28 September 2026.

## What the Data Shows

**~90%**

of girls said being sent explicit pictures or videos they did not want to see happens a lot or sometimes to them or their peers (boys: nearly 50%)

Ofsted, 2021

**122,768**

child sexual abuse and exploitation offences recorded by police in England and Wales in 2024

VKPP, 2025

**50%**

of those offences were committed by children aged 10 to 17

VKPP, 2025

**3x**

children with disabilities are three times more likely to be abused than their peers

KCSIE 2026

Ofsted visited 32 schools and colleges and spoke to more than 900 children and young people (published June 2021). Police figures show recorded crime, not how common abuse is; many children never report. Checked 28 September 2026.

**E**

## ENGAGE: Listen, Believe, Don't Investigate

**Your job is to receive the disclosure, not to establish the facts. Stay calm, listen, use their words, and ask only open questions. Use TED, never "why".**

## What the Student Might Say

*"Can I talk to you about something? It's really awkward. There's this boy in my year and he keeps sending me stuff. And at the party on Saturday he... he touched me. I didn't want him to."*

*"I don't want to get him in trouble. I just want it to stop."*

## The RESPOND Disclosure Script

*"I believe you, and I'm taking what you've told me seriously. This is not your fault. I'm going to help keep you safe, and I'll explain what happens next."*

- **Thank them:** "Thank you for telling me. I know that wasn't easy."
- **Stay with them:** face them, keep your voice level, and let silence happen. Don't show shock or disgust, even if you feel it. Your calm is contagious.
- **Use their language:** if they say "touched me", say "touched", not "assaulted". Reflect back: "So he touched you when you didn't want him to."

## TED Questions: Open, Never Leading

- **Tell:** "Tell me what happened." "Tell me about the messages."
- **Explain:** "Explain what you mean by 'stuff'." "Explain what happened next."
- **Describe:** "Describe where you were." "Describe how you're feeling now."
- You can ask whether they have been hurt and what the harm was, and ask where, when and who; avoid leading questions (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 558).
- Ask only what you need for immediate safety and the basic facts. The DSL, and possibly the police, will hear the full account; repeated retelling can be harmful and can affect evidence.

### If They Offer to Show You the Messages

*"Thank you for offering, but I'm not going to look at them. You don't need to show anyone. Please don't delete anything for now, and keep your phone with you. Our safeguarding lead will talk to you about what happens with the messages."*

- Never view, copy, print, share, store or save an image of a child, and never ask the student to show, send or download it (UKCIS). If you see one by accident, tell the DSL and ask for support.
- Don't delete it and don't ask the student to delete it. Don't take the phone unless the DSL asks you to.

### Helpful

- "You did the right thing telling me."
- "What happened is not your fault, whatever was happening at the party."
- "You don't need to give me all the details."

### Unhelpful

- "Why didn't you tell someone sooner?" (blame; delay is common)
- "Were you drinking?" "What were you wearing?" "Boys will be boys." (blame, minimising)
- "Why didn't you say no?" "Did you lead him on?" (blame)
- "I won't tell anyone." (a promise you can't keep)

## Questions They May Ask You

- **"Am I in trouble for being at the party?"** "Right now I'm concerned about you and whether you're safe. What happened to you is not your fault, wherever you were."
- **"Will he get in trouble?"** "I can't tell you what will happen. What you've told me is serious, and the people whose job it is will decide next steps. My job is to make sure you're safe and supported."

### Two Questions Staff Ask

- **"It happened at the weekend, outside school. Is it ours?"** Yes. KCSIE Part five covers incidents outside school and online (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 529).
- **"The student now says they made it up."** Children sometimes withdraw what they said, for many reasons, including fear or pressure. Record their exact words and tell the DSL. Deciding what is true is not your job, and support continues. If a report is found to be unfounded, the DSL considers whether the child needs support or has been harmed by someone else (paragraph 620).

### If You Witness It

If you see the other student approaching, filming or taunting the student, act **if it is safe to do so**, using the 4Ds: **Direct** ("Stop that now"), **Distract** (give the student a reason to come with you), **Delegate** (get a colleague or the DSL), **Delay** (check in privately afterwards). Don't discuss the allegation in front of others. Then tell the DSL.



## SUPPORT: Safety First

**Before anything else: is the student safe now, are they hurt, and where is the other student? Then give them a safe place, time and reassurance.**

## Safety Check

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### Physical and Medical

- "Are you hurt, or in any pain?"
- "Is there anything you need right now?"
- If there is an injury or urgent need: first aid or 999, then the DSL.

### Today in School

- "Is he in school today? Do you have any lessons with him?"
- "Are you worried about seeing him, or his friends?"
- "Has he tried to contact you since?"

### Online

- "Are the messages still coming?"
- "Do you know if anything from the party has been shared?"
- Don't ask to see anything. Pass what they tell you to the DSL.

### Going Home

- "Do you feel safe going home today?"

## Immediate Support

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- A private, quiet space where they won't be seen by other students; water; tissues; time
- The option not to go straight back to a lesson, especially one the other student is in

- Stay with them, or with a colleague they trust, until the DSL is involved

### **Evidence: Preserve, Don't Investigate**

- **Messages:** ask the student not to delete anything for now. Don't view, copy, screenshot, forward or delete. The DSL decides whether a device should be secured and handed to the police (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 558).
- **If the assault was very recent,** tell the DSL straight away: the police or a SARC advise on forensic evidence. The NHS advises trying not to wash or change clothes immediately after a sexual assault, and that it is still worth asking for advice about a forensic examination after more than 7 days (NHS).
- Don't examine the student, look at injuries beyond what first aid requires, collect clothing, or question witnesses.

### **SEND, Neurodivergence and Language**

- Allow extra processing time and a quiet space. Use clear, concrete language; avoid idioms and double questions.
- Some students with SEND may find it harder to recognise sexual harassment, to say no, or to be believed, and may be targeted because of that. KCSIE notes that children with disabilities are three times more likely to be abused than their peers (paragraph 532).
- Use a professional interpreter where language is a barrier, never another student or a family member.
- Record any adjustments you made.

### **Both Students Need Support**

The alleged perpetrator is a child too. Children who display harmful sexual behaviour have often experienced their own abuse and trauma (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 538). Support and sanctions can, and should, happen at the same time where needed (paragraph 632). The DSL plans any contact with the alleged perpetrator; you don't.

#### **For the Student Who Told You**

- A trusted adult of their choice (paragraph 624)
- A safety plan for school and online
- As normal a routine as possible, if they want it (paragraph 622)
- Not isolated from friends; somewhere to go if they need to withdraw (paragraph 626)

### For the Alleged Perpetrator

- Safeguarding support, and an education
- Help to understand and change harmful behaviour
- Protection from harassment by other students (paragraph 646)
- Accountability without shaming

## P

### PAUSE: Consider Your Approach

Act with composure. The Pause creates space between the disclosure and your response. Take 90 seconds: breathe, drop your shoulders, feel your feet on the floor, and check your own state before you act.

## Three Lenses

| Lens             | In this scenario                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Risk</b>      | Is the other student on site today, or in the student's next lesson? Are the messages continuing, or images being shared? Any injury, recent assault or risk of self-harm? Any risk at home?                                                                 |
| <b>Rights</b>    | The student's right to be believed, to be safe, to privacy, and to have as much control as reasonably possible over what happens next (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 571); the other student's rights as a child, and as someone not yet found to have done anything |
| <b>Resources</b> | The DSL and deputies; pastoral, counselling and health staff; the police, children's social care, a SARC, and specialist services; safe adults in the student's life                                                                                         |

If in doubt, N before O: tell the DSL before you offer the student options about what happens next.

## What You Must Not Do

### Don't Investigate

- Don't interview the other student, friends or anyone who was at the party

- Don't search social media or group chats, or scroll through the student's phone: sexual messages may include images
- Don't try to decide "what really happened"; that is for the DSL and, where involved, the police
- Curiosity is not neutral: it can drift into investigation, and can harm a police case

### **Don't Confront the Other Student**

- Don't warn them, ask for "their side", or tell them to "leave them alone"
- When and how the alleged perpetrator is told is decided by the DSL, usually with the police and children's social care (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 573)
- Never try to mediate or bring the students together

### **Don't Promise Secrecy**

Staff should never promise confidentiality when receiving a report (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 559).

*"I'm really glad you told me. I can't keep this completely to myself, because I'm worried about your safety. I need to speak to our safeguarding lead. I'll only share it with people who need to know, and I'll tell you what's happening at each step."*

### **Don't Blame or Minimise**

- No questions about drinking, clothing or why they went to the party
- Not "teenagers being teenagers" or "a party thing": KCSIE expects a zero-tolerance approach (paragraph 530)
- The only person responsible for a sexual assault is the person who did it

Don't promise outcomes either: what will happen to the other student, whether the police will be involved, or that parents won't be told.

## Check Your Own Response

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- Notice your reactions: shock, anger at the other student, protectiveness, or doubt. Keep them out of the conversation and out of the record.
- This may connect with your own experience. That is normal. You can still do your part, then get support (see *Looking After Yourself*).
- If you feel overwhelmed: "This is important and I want to get it right. Can you wait here with [colleague] while I get our safeguarding lead?"



### OFFER: Model Alternatives

**Offer proportionate options without coercion, explain honestly what happens next, and model what respect and consent look like. If in doubt, N before O: tell the DSL before offering options.**

## Explain What Happens Next

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*"Here's what happens now. I'm going to speak to our safeguarding lead, today, because what you've told me is serious and their job is to keep you safe. They'll probably want to talk with you, and I can be there if you'd like. We'll sort out where you go for the rest of today. Because you're under 18, your parents or carers will usually be told, and we'll talk with you about how. Sometimes the school has to involve other people, like the police or social care, to keep you and others safe; if that happens, we'll explain why. None of this is about getting you into trouble. What questions do you have?"*

Be honest about information sharing. Staff should share safeguarding information as early as possible, and data protection law does not prevent it; safeguarding children is a lawful basis for sharing sensitive information without consent where appropriate (KCSIE 2026, paragraphs 142 to 148). What is shared must be relevant, necessary and proportionate, go only to those who need it, and be handled in line with data protection law. From 30 September 2026, the Information Sharing Duty (section 16LA, Children Act 2004) also requires the organisations it covers to share where its tests are met; the DSL decides how it applies. So don't ask for consent as if it were the legal basis. Tell the student what will be shared, with whom and why, unless that would increase the risk, and listen to their views: they shape the plan. Agreeing to a service, such as counselling, is a separate question, and their agreement matters there.

KCSIE says the student should understand what the next steps will be and who the report will be passed to (paragraph 558). Where the DSL refers to children's social care or the police against the student's wishes, the decision is explained to them and specialist support offered (paragraph 563).

## Options, Not Orders

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- "Who would you like with you when you talk to the safeguarding lead?"
- "How would you like your parents to be told: with you there, or with us leading?"
- "What would make school feel safer for you tomorrow?"

Some things have to happen to keep them and others safe. Where there is a choice, give it to them: victims should have as much control as reasonably possible over how the report is progressed and what support they are offered (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 571).

## Model the Alternative

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### Respect and Consent

- Consent means having the freedom and capacity to choose. It can be withdrawn at any time, and it isn't there if someone is pressured, scared, or too drunk to choose
- Nobody is owed a reply, a photo or a touch
- Saying no, or saying nothing, is never an invitation
- Telling someone is the right thing to do

### Harm Presented as Normal

- "It was just a joke" or "everyone does it"
- Pressure to send pictures, or sending them unasked
- Touching at parties treated as part of the night
- Blaming the person for drinking, dressing or being there

Use the student's own words to reflect the difference. Preventative education on consent, for everyone, helps every student feel safe and respected (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 649).

## Support in School and Beyond

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- A trusted adult of their choice, and a daily check-in if they want it
- Counselling or pastoral support; the school nurse or health centre

- Tutors and key teachers told only what they need to know to support the student, as the DSL decides (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 566)
- Childline (for anyone under 19): 0800 1111, free and confidential; call any time, day or night, or use 1-2-1 chat at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk) (you may have to wait for a chat counsellor, so calling is usually quickest)
- Rape Crisis 24/7 Rape and Sexual Abuse Support Line (aged 16 and over): 0808 500 2222, free, any time, or online chat at [247sexualabusesupport.org.uk](https://www.247sexualabusesupport.org.uk). Under-16s can start with Childline
- Report Remove (Childline and the Internet Watch Foundation): for under-18s in the UK to report nude or sexual images or videos of themselves so they can be removed online, at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk)
- CEOP Safety Centre (National Crime Agency): report online sexual abuse, or worries about how someone has been communicating online, at [ceop.police.uk](https://www.ceop.police.uk)

## N NOTIFY: Tell the DSL

**Tell the DSL as soon as is practicably possible, and the same day. With a report of sexual assault where the other student may be in school, that means now, before the student goes back into the school day. If a child is in immediate danger, call 999.**

### Who and When

- Find the DSL in person, or phone: "I need to speak to you now about a disclosure of sexual harassment and possible sexual assault between students." Don't rely on email alone.
- If the DSL is not available, go to a deputy. If neither can be reached, go to a senior leader, or take advice from children's social care (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 61). Don't wait until the end of the day.
- If the DSL was not present during the report, they must be informed as soon as practically possible (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 558).
- Anyone can refer directly to children's social care if they believe a child is at risk; telling the DSL does not remove your own responsibility.

## What to Tell the DSL

- Who told you, when, where, and how the conversation started
- What they said, in their words: the messages, the touching, the party, when it happened
- Who the other student is, if named, and whether they are in school today or share lessons
- Whether images may be involved, and that you **did not** view them
- Any injury, pain or medical need; how the student is now; any risk of self-harm

- What the student wants, and what you have said and done so far
- Where the student is now, and who is with them

#### ▼ For the DSL: assessment, external agencies and parents

Most staff need only: tell the DSL, today, with the information above.

## The DSL's Initial Actions

- Lead the response, using professional judgement, case by case (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 549). If possible, a second member of staff is present when the report is taken further (paragraph 558).
- Following a report of sexual violence, carry out an **immediate risk and needs assessment** covering the victim's safety and support needs, potential other victims, the alleged perpetrator, the wider school community, and the location and time of the incident. For sexual harassment, consider case by case whether one is needed (paragraph 568). Record it, review it, and use it (paragraph 569); it does not replace professional assessments by social workers or sexual violence specialists (paragraph 570).
- Consider the victim's wishes, the nature of the incident, ages and development, any power imbalance, any pattern, and wider concerns including exploitation (paragraph 571).
- Immediate protection: consider straight away whether the students share classes, how to keep them a reasonable distance apart on site and on transport, and before and after school activities (paragraph 572). Where there is a criminal investigation into a sexual assault, the alleged perpetrator should be removed from classes shared with the victim (KCSIE 2026, Part five, 'Ongoing considerations'). These steps are not a judgement of guilt.
- Decide with the police and children's social care how and when the alleged perpetrator is told; don't delay immediate action to safeguard children (paragraph 573).
- Protect anonymity: decide which staff need to know (paragraph 566).
- Where the Information Sharing Duty applies (from 30 September 2026), apply its three tests: share information that is relevant to safeguarding or promoting the child's welfare (Relevance) and may help the recipient to safeguard or promote their welfare (May facilitate), unless sharing would be more detrimental to the child than not sharing (Detriment), which applies only in extremely limited circumstances; record the decision to share or not share, with the rationale, and be transparent with the young person unless that would increase the risk. Data protection law still applies to how information is shared (Information Sharing Duty statutory guidance).
- Record all concerns, discussions, decisions and their rationale in writing, with a chronology.

## The Four Options for Managing a Report

KCSIE describes four common routes (paragraph 574). They are not mutually exclusive. For a report that includes sexual touching without consent, the starting point is the police and children's

social care.

| Route                                          | When (KCSIE 2026 Part five)                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Manage internally                           | Some cases, such as one-off incidents of HSB or sexual harassment, using the behaviour policy and pastoral support without statutory services (paragraphs 575 to 577)                                                             |
| 2. Universal services and community Early Help | The children do not need statutory services but would benefit from support; can sit alongside managing internally, for both students (paragraphs 578 to 584)                                                                      |
| 3. Family Help and children's social care      | Where a child has been harmed, is at risk of harm, or is in immediate danger, refer to children's social care (paragraph 588). Don't wait for their investigation before protecting the victim and other children (paragraph 592) |
| 4. Reporting to the police                     | Where a report of rape, assault by penetration or sexual assault is made, the starting point is that it is passed to the police, generally in parallel with a referral to children's social care (paragraphs 596 and 598)         |

## The Explicit Messages (UKCIS)

- Follow UKCIS Sharing nudes and semi-nudes (2024): a proportionate safeguarding approach to every incident involving nudes or semi-nudes (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 530). Viewing is a DSL decision, only where unavoidable; confiscating devices to preserve evidence for the police may be more appropriate (paragraph 558).

### Police, SARC and Specialist Routes

- **Police:** 999 in an emergency; otherwise your local police via 101, following your local referral process. All police forces in England have specialist child abuse units (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 601). Agree with the police what can be shared with staff, the alleged perpetrator and parents (paragraph 599), and don't take actions that could jeopardise their investigation (paragraph 603).
- **SARC:** Sexual Assault Referral Centres offer crisis care, medical and forensic examinations and emergency contraception, for everyone regardless of age or when it happened, and you don't have to report to the police to use one (NHS). Find the nearest with the NHS SARC finder; if unsure, contact the GP or NHS 111 (paragraph 623).
- **Specialist support:** ChISVAs, via the police, social care, Rape Crisis or The Survivors Trust; children and young people's mental health services; the specialist sexual violence sector (paragraph 623).

- **For the alleged perpetrator:** advice from children's social care, specialist services and the police; Stop It Now and Shore (paragraph 632).

### Where a Student Is 18

At 18 a student is legally an adult. The child safeguarding framework in KCSIE applies to under-18s, but the school still has welfare responsibilities. Where an 18-year-old is involved, the DSL considers adult safeguarding, police and welfare pathways alongside the school's procedures, and the adult student's own views and consent in a different way. This matters in sixth form and in boarding, where students turn 18 during their final year.

### Sanctions and Support Together

A school can take disciplinary action while the police or children's social care investigate, and can reach its own view on the balance of probabilities, but must consider whether doing so would prejudice an investigation, and liaise carefully (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 636). Discipline and support are not mutually exclusive (paragraph 638). If the police take no further action, support continues for both students: an allegation that cannot be substantiated is not necessarily unfounded (paragraph 618).

### Before Contacting Parents or Carers

Schools will generally inform parents or carers at the point of referral, unless there are compelling reasons not to, for example if informing them would put the child at additional risk; that decision is made with children's social care (KCSIE 2026, paragraphs 589 and 600). Consider carefully what each family is told about the other child, and when (paragraph 639). Good practice is to meet the victim's parents with the victim present, and separately the alleged perpetrator's parents to explain arrangements and support (paragraphs 640 and 641).

### Parent contact: the student who told you

- "[Name] is safe and has been supported. They did the right thing in telling us, and it is not their fault."
- "We'd like to meet you, with [name] if they want, to talk about how we keep them safe and what support would help. How have they seemed at home?"

### Parent contact: the alleged perpetrator

- "This is an allegation. We haven't reached any conclusion, and we're treating it as a safeguarding matter for everyone involved."
- "[What can be shared, as agreed with the police or social care.] While this is looked into, we're making some arrangements, such as [timetable changes], and I'll explain why."
- "[Name] will be supported too. We'd like to meet you to talk it through."

## D DOCUMENT: Record What You Heard

Record as soon as is practicably possible, on the school's safeguarding system, using GOLD. Your notes may be used in statutory assessments or criminal investigations, so record only what the child says, without interpretation or opinion (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 558).

### GOLD

#### Ground

Date, time, place, who was present, who you are, and how it came to your attention

#### Observe

What you saw and heard, with exact words in quotation marks

#### Language

Neutral, factual and non-diagnostic. No opinions or labels

#### Do

What you did, what you said would happen next, and why

### Example: Exact Words

- Student said: "He keeps sending me stuff I didn't ask for. Pictures and that."
- Student said: "At Sam's party on Saturday he grabbed me, here [pointed to chest], and I pushed him off."
- Student said: "I don't want him to get in trouble. I just want it to stop."
- Observed: quiet, tearful; held their phone throughout; asked twice whether they were "in trouble"

- Did: did not view the messages (the student offered to show me); asked them not to delete anything; told them I would speak to the DSL today; DSL told in person at [time]

Give the student your full attention, then write the record straight after (paragraph 558). If you made a mistake, such as seeing an image by accident, record it honestly and tell the DSL.

### Recording template

SAFEGUARDING CONCERN: DISCLOSURE OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT OR SEXUAL VIOLENCE (CHILD-ON-CHILD)

Date and time of disclosure:

Date and time of this record:

Student who told: name, year, tutor group

Other student named (if any): name, year, tutor group

Recorded by: name and role

Where, who was present, and how the conversation started:

WHAT THE STUDENT SAID (exact words in quotation marks):

QUESTIONS I ASKED (my exact words):

WHEN AND WHERE THE STUDENT SAYS IT HAPPENED (as they described it):

ONLINE: messages or images mentioned (NOT viewed by me; not copied or forwarded):

OBSERVATIONS (presentation, emotional state; any injury mentioned or seen):

SAFETY: immediate risk / medical need / other student on site / going home

WHAT I DID AND SAID (with times):

SHARED WITH: DSL (name, time, in person or phone)

THE STUDENT'S WISHES (in their words):

Signed and dated:

### What Not to Record

- Opinions about either student, or about whether it happened
- Assumptions about the party, alcohol, clothing, families or culture
- Character references ("he's a lovely lad") or speculation about motives
- The content of any image. Record that images were mentioned; never copy, attach or describe an image

Store records only on the safeguarding system, never in personal notes, email drafts or on your phone. Don't discuss the disclosure in the staffroom or with colleagues who don't need to know.

## Online, Offsite and After the Party

The harm crossed phones, a party at the weekend, and school. The response has to cover all three.

- **Social media will shape the fallout.** There may be contact between the students online, and friends on either side may harass the victim or the alleged perpetrator, or be harassed themselves (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 647). Tell the DSL at once if you hear that images, a video or rumours are being shared; don't look for them yourself.
- **Other students who were there may need support.** Witnessing sexual violence is likely to be traumatic (paragraph 645). Don't question them about who hosted, who was drinking or what they saw; pass what you hear to the DSL.

## Boarding and Residential Life

For boarders, school is also home. A student may be living in the same house as the person they have reported, and the evenings and weekends are when support is thinnest.

| Step               | In boarding                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● <b>Recognise</b> | Use the 4 Ps for the house: who shares rooms, corridors, common rooms and prep; weekends, trips and exeats; phones after lights out; house group chats. Notice a boarder who avoids meals, a common room or a particular person. |
| ● <b>Engage</b>    | Boarders often tell house staff at informal times, late in the evening. Use TED and the script. Talk in a visible space with the door open, and let another adult know.                                                          |
| ● <b>Support</b>   | Safety tonight: where will they sleep, who is on duty, and how do they reach night staff? If both students board, any change to rooms, tables or routines should not fall on the student who told unless they ask for it.        |
| ● <b>Pause</b>     | If both students live in the same house, the risk continues all evening. Don't investigate, don't search rooms or phones, and don't promise secrecy. If there is immediate risk, don't wait until morning.                       |
| ● <b>Offer</b>     | Model alternatives: house expectations about consent, privacy, phones and visiting rooms; older boarders as positive role models. If in doubt, N before O.                                                                       |
| ● <b>Notify</b>    | Contact the on-call DSL or boarding deputy DSL straight away. If a child is in immediate danger and no DSL can be reached, call 999; out of hours, contact the local authority's emergency duty team.                            |

## Step

## In boarding

- Record on the safeguarding system before you go off duty, using GOLD. A house log or handover note is not a substitute.

### Document

### Boarders' Routes to Help

- **Boarders can always contact their house parents, the DSL or a member of the boarding management team, at any time, day or night.** Make sure every boarder knows how.
- An independent person outside the staff whom boarders can contact directly (NMS 11.4), often called the independent listener
- Boarders must be able to contact their families privately; monitoring of communications should be proportionate (NMS 12.1)
- International boarders: agree with the DSL who contacts parents or guardians, when, and in what language, using interpreters where needed

Source: National Minimum Standards for Boarding Schools (2026).

## Identity and Intersecting Harm

- **Barriers to telling:** KCSIE asks staff to keep in mind that some children face additional barriers to disclosure, especially those with vulnerabilities related to disability, sex, ethnicity or sexual orientation (KCSIE 2026, paragraph 558).
- **Girls** are more likely to be victims of sexual harassment and sexual violence, and boys more likely to perpetrate it (paragraph 532). That shapes prevention; it never decides an individual case.
- **Boys can be victims too**, and may be less likely to tell, or to be believed. They may fear being laughed at, or feel they should have "handled it". Respond in exactly the same way. KCSIE points to Rape Crisis, The Survivors Trust and the Male Survivors Partnership for specialist services, including for boys and men (paragraph 623).
- **LGBTQ+ students** may be harassed about their sexuality or gender, threatened with being "outed", or worried that telling will out them. Don't assume the gender of anyone involved, and never share a student's sexuality or gender identity without their agreement unless there is a safeguarding reason, as the DSL decides. Galop Children and Young People's Service (LGBT+ young people aged 13 to 25, with a specialist sexual violence advocate): if you are under 18, use the online form at [galop.org.uk/make-a-referral](https://galop.org.uk/make-a-referral), or call Childline on 0800 1111.

- **SEND and neurodivergent students** may be targeted, may find it harder to recognise or describe what happened, and may be less likely to be believed. Some may display harmful sexual behaviour without understanding its impact; the behaviour still needs a safeguarding response. Children with disabilities are three times more likely to be abused than their peers (paragraph 532).
- **Race and stereotypes** can affect who is believed and who is seen as a threat, including assumptions that some children are older or less vulnerable than they are.
- **Culture, faith and family:** some students fear shame or blame at home. The DSL considers this before contacting parents; pass any concern about honour-based abuse to the DSL straight away.



## Looking After Yourself

Hearing a disclosure of sexual harm affects adults too. Looking after yourself is part of safeguarding, not separate from it.

- You may feel shock, sadness or anger, worry about whether you did it right, or be stirred up if it connects with your own experience. That is normal.
- Debrief with the DSL the same day, and take a few minutes before your next lesson if you can.
- Talk in confidence to your line manager, supervision, or the school's Employee Assistance Programme if it has one. If thoughts about it keep intruding or your sleep is affected, get support early.
- Education Support: 08000 562 561, free, confidential, 24/7, for education staff
- Samaritans: 116 123, free, any time



## Additional Resources and Support

### For Students

- Childline (for anyone under 19): 0800 1111, free and confidential; call any time, day or night, or use 1-2-1 chat at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk) (you may have to wait for a chat counsellor, so calling is usually quickest)
- Rape Crisis 24/7 Rape and Sexual Abuse Support Line (aged 16 and over): 0808 500 2222, free, any time, or online chat at [247sexualabusesupport.org.uk](https://247sexualabusesupport.org.uk). Under-16s can start with Childline
- Report Remove (Childline and the Internet Watch Foundation): for under-18s in the UK to report nude or sexual images or videos of themselves so they can be removed online, at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk)

- CEOP Safety Centre (National Crime Agency): report online sexual abuse, or worries about how someone has been communicating online, at [ceop.police.uk](https://ceop.police.uk)
- Galop Children and Young People's Service (LGBT+ young people aged 13 to 25, with a specialist sexual violence advocate): if you are under 18, use the online form at [galop.org.uk/make-a-referral](https://galop.org.uk/make-a-referral), or call Childline on 0800 1111
- Shore (Lucy Faithfull Foundation): [shorespace.org.uk](https://shorespace.org.uk), a safe, anonymous place for young people worried about their own sexual thoughts or behaviour, or someone else's

### For Parents and Carers

- NSPCC Helpline: 0808 800 5000 (Monday to Friday 10am to 4pm), or [help@nspcc.org.uk](mailto:help@nspcc.org.uk)
- NSPCC Report Abuse in Education helpline: 0800 136 663 (Monday to Friday 8am to 8pm; Saturday and Sunday 9am to 6pm), for staff, parents and young people concerned about sexual abuse or harassment in education
- Stop It Now (Lucy Faithfull Foundation): 0808 1000 900, confidential, and you can stay anonymous; for anyone worried about a child or young person's sexual behaviour, including parents and professionals. Live chat and secure email at [stopitnow.org.uk](https://stopitnow.org.uk)
- YoungMinds Parents Helpline: 0808 802 5544 (Monday, Thursday and Friday 9:30am to 4pm; Tuesday and Wednesday 9:30am to 6pm)

### For Staff and the DSL

- UK Safer Internet Centre Professionals Online Safety Helpline: [helpline@saferinternet.org.uk](mailto:helpline@saferinternet.org.uk) (email, Monday to Friday, working hours), for anyone working with children
- The Survivors Trust helpline (aged 16 and over): 0808 801 0818 (Monday to Thursday 10am to 12:30pm, 1:30pm to 3pm and 6pm to 8pm; Friday 10am to 12:30pm and 1:30pm to 3pm; Saturday 10am to 12:30pm; Sunday 6pm to 8pm)
- NHS: Find a rape and sexual assault referral centre
- NHS: Help after rape and sexual assault
- Education Support: 08000 562 561, free, confidential, 24/7, for education staff

## Statutory Guidance and Law

- Department for Education, *Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026* (Part five: child-on-child sexual harassment and sexual violence)
- HM Government, *Working Together to Safeguard Children 2026*
- Department for Education, *Information Sharing Duty: statutory guidance* (in force 30 September 2026)

- Department for Education, *Information sharing duty: statutory guidance* (PDF)
- UKCIS, *Sharing nudes and semi-nudes: advice for education settings working with children and young people* (2024)
- Department for Education, *RSHE statutory guidance* (published July 2025; statutory from September 2026)
- Department for Education, *National minimum standards for boarding schools* (2026)
- Sexual Offences Act 2003, section 3 (sexual assault)
- Sexual Offences Act 2003, section 66A (sending a photograph or film of genitals)
- Protection of Children Act 1978, section 1 (indecent photographs of children)
- Crown Prosecution Service, *Youth crime* (age of criminal responsibility)

## Figures

- Ofsted, *Review of sexual abuse in schools and colleges* (June 2021)
- Vulnerability Knowledge and Practice Programme (National Police Chiefs' Council), *National Analysis of Police-Recorded Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation Crimes Report 2024* (December 2025)

Contacts, figures and legal references checked 28 September 2026. Verify at point of use.

## Quick Reference Card

### Immediate Danger Comes First

**Immediate danger or possible risk to life:** call 999 when it is needed, stay with the child, and summon the DSL or a deputy. Don't delay action to work through the steps. The 90-second Pause is for once immediate safety is secured, to stop an impulsive or investigative response.

### Recognise

- Unwanted sexual messages, images or comments: sexual harassment
- Sexual touching without consent: possible sexual assault
- Online, offsite and at the weekend all count
- No disclosure needed; no need to wait for it to happen again

### Respond

- "I believe you, and I'm taking what you've told me seriously. This is not your fault."
- TED, never "why"; use their words

- Never view, copy, forward or delete images
- Don't promise secrecy; don't confront the other student

### Notify

- DSL as soon as is practicably possible; for a report of sexual assault, now
- Immediate danger: 999; urgent medical need: first aid or 999, then the DSL
- If in doubt, N before O
- Both students need a safeguarding response

### Document

- GOLD: Ground, Observe, Language, Do
- Exact words, and the questions you asked
- Record that you did not view images; never describe an image

### Key Numbers

- Emergency: 999; police non-emergency: 101; NHS 111
- Childline (for anyone under 19): 0800 1111, free and confidential; call any time, day or night, or use 1-2-1 chat at [childline.org.uk](https://www.childline.org.uk) (you may have to wait for a chat counsellor, so calling is usually quickest)
- Rape Crisis 24/7 Rape and Sexual Abuse Support Line (aged 16 and over): 0808 500 2222, free, any time
- NSPCC Report Abuse in Education helpline: 0800 136 663 (Monday to Friday 8am to 8pm; Saturday and Sunday 9am to 6pm), for staff, parents and young people concerned about sexual abuse or harassment in education
- Your DSL: named in the school's safeguarding policy

### Online Evidence: One Rule

- **Ordinary messages or posts a student has already shown you:** note what is relevant (platform, date, who, exact words) in your record. Don't ask to see more or scroll through a phone, especially where messages may be sexual, because they may contain images. Don't log in to accounts, search profiles or investigate, and never transfer anything to a personal device.

- **Nude or semi-nude images of anyone under 18:** don't intentionally view, copy, screenshot, forward, save or delete them. Tell the DSL straight away. If you see one by accident, tell the DSL, ask for support if you need it, and record that it was seen and what you did, without describing the image (UKCIS).
- The DSL decides what happens to devices and content.

## Your School's Contacts

This guide is generic. Schools add their own details here, or keep a completed copy with this card, so that anyone responding, including at night, has the routes to hand.

| Contact                                                | Name and how to reach them |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)                     |                            |
| Deputy DSL(s)                                          |                            |
| Out-of-hours and boarding on-call safeguarding contact |                            |
| How to record a concern (system or form)               |                            |
| Local authority children's services front door         |                            |
| Out-of-hours emergency duty team                       |                            |
| LADO (concerns about adults)                           |                            |
| Police: 999 (emergency); 101 (non-emergency)           |                            |

## **RESPOND** Safeguarding Framework Reference Scenarios · Staff Guide 2

### Scenario 2: Allegation of Sexual Harassment or Sexual Violence

© 2026/27 | **RESPOND** Safeguarding Framework

Aligned with: KCSIE 2026 (Part five) | Working Together to Safeguard Children 2026 | Information Sharing Duty (September 2026) | UKCIS Sharing nudes and semi-nudes (2024) | Sexual Offences Act 2003 | RSHE statutory guidance (published July 2025; statutory from September 2026) | NMS for Boarding Schools 2026

Last Updated: September 2026 | Next Review: September 2027, or on publication of KCSIE 2027 if sooner

For staff in schools and other settings working with children. You may share it with colleagues. Share the student and parent guides, not this page, with students and families.